

The Constitution of the



CONTENTS

ADDRESS	4
PREAMBLE	4
ARTICLE I: NAME	4
Section 1: Official Name	4
Section 2: Period of Duration	4
Section 3: Nonprofit Status	4
Section 4: Fiscal Year	4
Section 5: Disclosure of the Organization Finances	4
ARTICLE II: OBJECTIVES / PURPOSES	4
Section 1: Outline	4
ARTICLE III: MEMBERSHIP	5
Section 1: Members	5
Section 2: Active Membership or Member(s) in Good Standing	5
Section 3: Introductory Period	6
Section 4: Attendance at Mandatory Events	6
Section 5: Deregistration and Re-Registration	6
Section 6: Associate Member(s)	6
Section 7: Affiliate Member(s)	6
Section 8: Honorary Member(s)	7
Section 9: Rights	7
ARTICLE IV: ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE	7
Section 1: General Assembly	7
Section 2: Executive Committee	7
Section 3: Board of Trustees	7
Section 4: Standing and Ad-hoc Committees	7
ARTICLE V: DUTIES OF OFFICERS	8
Section 1: The President	8
Section 2: The Vice President	8
Section 3: The Secretary	8
Section 4: The Treasurer	8
Section 5: Financial Secretary	9
Section 6: Public Relations Officer	9
Section 7: Protocol Officer	9
ARTICLE VI: STANDING AND AD-HOC COMMITTEES	9
Section 1: Executive Committee	9
Section 2: Board of Trustees	10
Section 3: Cultural Committee	10
Section 4: Education Committee	11

Section 5: Welfare Committee	11
Section 6: Audit Committee	11
Section 7: Disciplinary Committee	12
Section 8: Constitution Review Committee	12
Section 9: Fundraising Committee	12
Section 10: Electoral Committee	12
Section 11: Membership Drive Committee	13
Section 12: Dissolution of Committees	13
ARTICLE VII: TERM OF OFFICE	13
Section 1: Executive Members	13
Section 2: Board of Trustees	14
ARTICLE VIII: ELECTION / REMOVAL OF OFFICERS	14
Section 1: Election Bill	14
Section 2: Election Procedures	14
Section 3: Eligibility	14
Section 4: Conditions for Removal / Dismissal of Officer(s)	15
Section 5: Procedure for Dismissal of Officer(s)	15
ARTICLE IX: MEETINGS	15
Section 1: Frequency	15
Section 2: Special / Emergency Meetings	16
Section 3: Quorum	16
ARTICLE X: REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND BANKING	16
Section 1: Sources of Revenues	16
Section 2: Dues	16
Section 3: Expenditures	16
Section 4: Banking And Accounts	16
Section 5: Financial Expenditure Authority	17
Section 6: Methods of Payments Requiring Authorization	17
ARTICLE XI: AWARDS	17
Section 1: Privileges	17
Section 2: Nomination	17
Section 3: Presentation	17
ARTICLE XII: ANNUAL EVENTS	18
ARTICLE XIII: GENERAL PROVISIONS	18
Section 1: Suspension of Mandatory Requirements	18
Section 2: Extraordinary Circumstances	18
Section 3: Limitations	19
ARTICLE XIV: ADDENDUMS	19
ARTICLE XV: AMENDMENTS / RATIFICATION	19

ADDRESS:

UNITED ESAN ORGANIZATION (UEO)
P.O. Box 1464
ALIEF, TEXAS, 77411- 1464

PREAMBLE

(STATE OF TEXAS) (HARRIS COUNTY) -- KNOW ALL MEN BY THESE PRESENTS:

THAT the United Esan Organization (UEO), Houston, Texas, shall be a non-profit, non-political Organization, whose purpose shall be to preserve and promote the Esan cultural heritage, to enhance the welfare of the indigenous people of Esan land; and to encourage mutual cooperation among the Esans, Edo indigenes, other Nigerians in the United States of America and elsewhere. The United Esan Organization hereafter referred to as the Organization shall conduct its activities within the confines of this Constitution and subsequent amendments duly adopted.

ARTICLE I: NAME

Section 1: Official Name

The United Esan Organization (UEO) shall be the official name by which the Organization conducts its activities and businesses.

Section 2: Period of Duration

The period of duration of the Organization shall be perpetual.

Section 3: Nonprofit Status

- (a) The Organization shall be a nonprofit Organization.
- (b) The Organization's funds, interests or dividends shall not be paid to its members.
- (c) At the end of each fiscal year, the balance of all the Organization's funds from the passing fiscal year shall automatically be transferred to the funds for the new fiscal year.
- (d) Upon discontinuance, the organization's assets will be transferred to a charitable organization that is qualified for exemption under the Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), as amended.

Section 4: Fiscal Year

The Organization's fiscal year shall begin on *January 1* and end on *December 31* of each year.

Section 5: Disclosure of the Organization Finances

- (a) Monthly briefings of the Organization finances shall be made available to members during its General Assembly meetings.
- (b) The Organization's financial statements shall be provided monthly to members during its General Assembly meetings.
- (c) Any active member, being one whose financial obligations to the Organization are current, may submit a written request to examine the Organization's financial records. Such a request shall be submitted no less than two (2) weeks prior to the monthly general meeting, to enable the Executive Committee to prepare and present a response at the meeting.
- (d) The Organization shall submit an annual financial report to the Internal Revenue Services (IRS).

ARTICLE II: OBJECTIVES / PURPOSES

Section 1: Outline

- (a) To preserve and promote Esan cultural heritage.
- (b) To promote the interest and welfare of all its members.

- (c) To promote cooperation, harmony, and unity among members.
- (d) To promote commerce and educational excellence of all its members.
- (e) To encourage all members to be law abiding.
- (f) To enhance communication and dissemination of information among members,
- (g) To create a forum for intellectual and sociological exchange of ideas.
- (h) To promote and encourage patriotic habits amongst members, other Nigerians and the rest of the world at large.

ARTICLE III: MEMBERSHIP

Section 1: Members shall be:

Any Male indigene of a Local Government Area (LGA) falling within the boundaries of Esan Land of Edo State of Nigeria.

Section 2: Active Membership or Member(s) in Good Standing:

- (a) All members as defined in Section 1 above shall submit a one-time, non-refundable membership registration fee of fifty dollars (\$50.00) with his application.
- (b) All members who joined the Organization after January 2009 are required to pay the membership registration fee.
- (c) A potential member becomes a registered member only when his application materials and membership registration fee are received by the Financial Secretary and approved by the General Assembly.
- (d) All members who joined the organization from inception are exempted from paying membership registration fee but will be required to complete and submit a membership application for UEO records.
- (e) All members shall demonstrate commitment by agreeing to serve on committees assigned to them by the Executive Committee, using their talents, experience, and education for the benefit of the Organization.
- (f) To remain active and qualify for benefits, a member must be in **“good standing”** for at least one (1) full year. A member is considered in good standing if he attends at **least two-thirds** (eight meetings) of the General Assembly meetings in one year and does not owe more than **three (3) months** of dues, approved levies, and fines except in the following cases:

(i) Illness:

Payment of dues may be suspended upon written notification of illness by a member to the Executive Committee, provided that such illness is verified by the Committee.

- a. If recovery occurs within six months, all dues in arrears must be paid.
- b. If illness lasts more than six months, dues are waived until the member fully recovers and can resume active participation.
- c. Benefit eligibility shall be based on the member’s standing immediately before the illness started.

(ii) Involuntary Unemployment or Business Loss:

A member with documented involuntary unemployment or involuntary loss, suspension, or closure of a small business must attend at least two-thirds (eight meetings) of General Assembly meetings in a fiscal year.

- a. Dues are waived until employment status or business operations resume.
- b. The member must notify the Organization in writing through the Executive Committee and provide reasonable documentation of such unemployment or business loss.
- c. Benefit eligibility shall be based on the member’s standing immediately before the waiver began.
- d. For purposes of this subsection, “small business loss” includes permanent or temporary closure, significant loss of income, or cessation of operations due to economic conditions, government action, or other circumstances beyond the member’s control.

(iii) Work or Travel Obligations:

A member with documented work-related or travel commitments, submitted in writing to the Executive Committee, may, upon approval of the Executive Committee, be permitted to attend General Assembly meetings through approved virtual means (including Zoom). Such virtual attendance shall count toward

meeting attendance requirements. The member must attend a minimum of five (5) regularly scheduled General Assembly meetings within a fiscal year and be current on all dues to remain an active member in good standing. Where virtual attendance is impracticable, the Executive Committee may grant an excused absence for a reasonable period, with notice to the General Assembly.

Section 3: Orientation (or Introductory) Period:

- (a) Each new member shall serve a six-month orientation (or introductory) period beginning on the date their registration is approved. During this period, the member must attend four (4) out of six (6) general meetings and pay dues in full for the six months.
- (b) Time successfully served during orientation (or introductory) period shall count toward the one-year good-standing requirement for benefits.
- (c) A member on orientation (or introductory) period may not hold any official position but may serve as a member (not Chairperson) of an Ad-hoc committee as decided by the Executive Committee. He must meet the “good standing” requirements in Article III, Section 2(f) to qualify for benefits.

Section 4. Attendance at Mandatory Events

- (a) Members must attend all compulsory events unless their absence is excused due to verified work-related or travel obligations, as provided in Article III, Section 2(f).
- (b) Compulsory events include General Meetings; wake-keeping for a member or a member’s spouse; traditional weddings of active members’ children; and any social/cultural events designated as compulsory by the Executive Committee and approved by the General Assembly.
- (c) A member shall **not** be eligible to invite or host the Organization for any event classified as a UEO compulsory event if that member is not in good standing **or** has missed more than four (4) compulsory UEO events within one year.
- (d) The Organization shall not schedule more than one mandatory event within any calendar month, except in cases of emergency.
- (e) Mandatory events shall not overlap with any other official event of the Organization. Scheduling of any mandatory event require a minimum notice period of one month and must be presented and approved at the General Assembly meeting immediately preceding the proposed event date.

Section 5. Deregistration and Re-registration

- (a) Any member who is absent from the Organization for two (2) consecutive years, and not in good standing, shall be automatically deregistered.
- (b) Any member delinquent in dues for two (2) years, regardless of attendance at General Assembly meetings or events shall be ineligible for benefits and shall also be automatically deregistered.
- (c) No dues or fees shall accrue after deregistration.
- (d) Re-registration is required, but no new registration fee or orientation time shall apply.
- (e) To re-register, a former member must fully pay all outstanding dues accrued up to the time they stopped attending meetings. Upon re-registration, the member shall be restored, subject to the same good-standing requirements applicable to all members.

Section 6: Associate Members:

Associate Members are individuals who:

- (a) Meet the membership criteria in Section 1 and reside in Houston, Texas or elsewhere worldwide; and
- (b) Pay dues regularly as required by this Constitution.

Section 7: Affiliate Members:

Affiliate Members are individuals who:

- (a) Are Esan indigenes who reside outside Houston, Texas and its surrounding areas; **or**
- (b) Are men who are not of Esan descent but are legally married to Esan women and have been vetted by the Executive Committee and approved by the General Assembly;
- (c) Pay dues regularly as required by this Constitution; and
- (d) Are ineligible to serve as President or Vice President.

Section 8: Honorary Members:

Honorary Member status may be conferred on non-Esan individuals who demonstrate outstanding character, integrity, reputation, and contributions to UEO.

- (a) Any member may nominate a candidate for Executive Committee review and, if approved, presentation to the General Assembly for final approval;
- (b) Honorary Members are exempt from dues but may offer financial or in-kind support; and
- (c) Honorary Members may invite UEO to their special events, subject to Executive Committee approval.

Section 9: Rights

- (a) At General Assembly meetings, all members defined in Article III, Sections (2) and (3) shall have the right to speak and contribute to UEO deliberations, as well as the right to vote and, if qualified, be voted for.
- (b) Only Active Members in good standing, as defined in Article III, Section 2(f), are eligible for election as Officers of the Organization; however, Affiliate Members may not serve as President or Vice President. A member who meets all good standing requirements except for owing no more than three (3) months of dues may still run for office, provided all outstanding dues are paid on or before the nomination deadline.
- (c) Only Active Members in good standing may formally invite the Organization to personal, social, or cultural events.
A member who is not in good standing may issue an invitation only after settling all outstanding financial obligations to the Organization. Such invitations shall not qualify for financial support from UEO for the occasion, though members may provide voluntary support.

ARTICLE IV: ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

The organizational structure of the United Esan Organization shall comprise the General Assembly, the Executive Committee, the Board of Trustees, Standing and Ad-hoc Committees.

Section 1: General Assembly

- (a) The General Assembly shall consist of all members in good standing.
- (b) The duties of the General Assembly shall include but are not limited to election of the members of the Executive Committee and the Board of Trustees; approval or disapproval of any constitutional amendments, review any decision(s) and/or action(s) of the Executive Committee.
- (c) Regular meetings of the General Assembly shall be open to all members as defined in all sections of ARTICLE III.

Section 2: Executive Committee

The Executive Committee shall constitute the administrative authority of the Organization and shall be composed of the President, who shall serve as head, the Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, and Public Relations Officer.

Section 3: Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees shall be the advisory council of the Organization; consisting of no more than five (5) members.

Section 4: Standing and Ad-hoc Committees:

- (a) The committees shall support the Organization in specific areas to ensure smooth operations without relying solely on executive leadership.
- (b) Committee appointments shall be made by the President or Executive Committee, except for the Electoral Committee, which shall be appointed by the Board of Trustees.
- (c) Members may serve on one or more committees based on their experience, qualifications, and availability.

ARTICLE V: DUTIES OF OFFICERS**Section 1: President**

The President Shall:

- (a) Be the official representative of the Organization at all times.
- (b) Preside over all meetings of the General Assembly and those of the Executive Committee.
- (c) Call all regular and emergency meetings of the General Assembly as needed.
- (d) Delegate parts of his duties and/or authorities to the members of the executive committee on a temporary basis, as necessary.
- (e) Appoint an interim officer to the executive committee in case of a vacancy due to resignation or inability of an executive member to complete his term of office prior to the next election.
- (f) Act on behalf of the Organization in emergency situations in consultation with the other executive members when necessary.
- (g) Act in non-emergency situations on behalf of the Organization with the consent of the general membership and Board of Trustees
- (h) Co-sign as required, all checks and financial transactions/disbursements on behalf of the Organization.
- (i) Have the authority to constitute or reconstitute Standing and Ad Hoc Committees in consultation with the other Executive Committee Members.

Section 2: Vice President

The Vice President Shall:

- (a) Assist the President to run the affairs of the Organization.
- (b) Temporarily assume the President's duties when so directed or in the President's absence.
- (c) Assume the President's duties in the event of resignation, removal, or inability to complete the term. In such cases, the Vice President shall serve as Acting President until the next election.

Section 3: Secretary

The Secretary Shall:

- (a) Keep records of all proceedings of the executive committee, and that of the General Assembly as well as to keep attendance list of all General Assembly meetings and other activities sponsored by the Organization.
- (b) Assist the President in preparing the agendas of the General Assembly meetings and other similar documents.
- (c) Be responsible for all official correspondence of the Organization.
- (d) (i) Temporarily assume the duties of the President whenever the office of the President and the Vice President are vacant simultaneously due to their removal or inability to complete their terms of office.
(ii) In such a case, the Board of Trustees shall call emergency meeting of the General Assembly to elect a new w President and Vice President within two weeks
- (e) Co-sign as required, all checks and financial transactions on behalf of the organization when either the President or Treasurer is unavailable or unable to sign.

Section 4: Treasurer

The Treasurer Shall:

- (a) Be the chief custodian of the organization's funds.
- (b) Keep accurate records and receipts of all financial transactions of the Organization and make all duly authorized payments/bank deposits.
- (c) Submit a detailed account of all revenues and expenditures of the Organization to the General Assembly on a monthly and yearly basis.
- (d) Present an accurate financial report at all General Assembly meetings.
- (e) Be responsible for the collection of and proper recording of membership fees, monthly dues, special contributions, and/or levies in the absence of the Financial Secretary.

- (f) Collaborate with the Executive Committee to prepare the annual budget and submit it to the Board of Trustees for review and approval.
- (g) Present the approved annual budget to the General Assembly.
- (f) Co-sign as required, all checks and financial transactions/disbursements on behalf of the Organization.
- (g) Make bank deposits within two (2) business days of all monies collected on behalf of the Organization
- (i) Cooperate with the Audit Committee or external auditors, as needed, in the performance of their duties.
- (j) File all required government reports, in collaboration with an approved CPA when necessary, to ensure compliance with statutory requirements.

Section 5: Financial Secretary

The Financial Secretary Shall:

- (a) Collect, record, and reconcile all monies due to the Organization, including dues, levies, and special contributions.
- (b) Promptly hand over all funds collected to the Treasurer for deposit, or deposit them within two (2) business days in the absence of the Treasurer.
- (c) Assist the Treasurer in reconciling accounts, preparing financial reports, and maintaining proper financial documentation.
- (d) Present an accurate financial report to the General Assembly in the absence of the Treasurer.

Section 6: The Public Relations Officer

The Public Relation Officer Shall:

- (a) Organize and implement publicity work for the various events sponsored by the Organization.
- (b) Draft and distribute announcements to the General Assembly.
- (c) Support the Cultural Committee in organizing cultural events.
- (d) Assist the Financial Secretary in collecting voluntary contributions for social and cultural events.
- (e) Organize and supervise the production of a periodical Newsletter on behalf of the Organization.
- (f) Serve in an advisory capacity to the Membership Drive Committee and help coordinate membership recruitment initiatives.

Section 7: Protocol Officer

Not an elected officer or member of the Executive Committee but appointed by the reigning President and approved by the General Assembly.

The Protocol Officer Shall:

- (a) Maintain order and enforce discipline during General Assembly meetings as authorized by the President, ensuring proceedings are respectful and distraction-free.
- (b) Monitor and discourage disruptions, including unnecessary noise, whispers, and side conversations.
- (c) Ensure speaking rules are followed by allowing only one person to speak at a time and requiring recognition before speaking.
- (d) Assist the President in determining the order of speakers.
- (e) Fulfill any additional responsibilities assigned by the President.

ARTICLE VI: STANDING AND AD-HOC COMMITTEES

Section 1: Executive Committee

- (a) The Executive Committee shall consist of the President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary and Public Relations Officer. The President shall preside at all meetings, or the Vice President in his absence.
- (b) No executive member shall be re-elected for the same position for more than two consecutive terms, a term being two (2) years.
- (d) Elections for executive members shall be held in the month of June every other year at the General Assembly meeting.

- (e) Members elected to executive positions shall be sworn-in in the month of July following the month of June they were elected.
- (f) **The Functions of the Executive Committee:**
 - (i) Uphold the constitution of the Organization and ensure transparency in all organizational matters and member affairs.
 - (ii) Oversee the day-to-day administration and operations of the organization
 - (iii) Make interim decisions on urgent matters between General Assembly meetings.
 - (iv) Promote the goals and objectives of the Organization.
 - (v) Implement the resolution(s) or decision(s) made and agreed upon by the General Assembly.
 - (vi) Summon the meetings of the General Assembly.
 - (vii) Seek legitimate sources of revenue and other resources for the Organization.
 - (viii) Serve as the official voice of the organization in external matters.
 - (ix) Appoint and dismiss committees and their membership as necessary
 - (x) Submit to the General Assembly an annual report of all activities and the financial expenses incurred by the Organization.
 - (xi) Prepare and submit annual budget to the General Assembly for approval.
 - (xii) Facilitate a smooth transition of leadership at the end of its term.
 - (xiii) Ensure the transfer of all records, documents, and organizational assets to the incoming Administration within two weeks.
 - (xiv) Perform any other duties as deemed necessary by the General Assembly.

Section 2: Board of Trustees

- (a) The Board shall consist of five (5) members, elected by the General Assembly.
- (b) No Board member shall be re-elected for the same position for more than two consecutive terms, a term being two (2) years.
- (c) Board members election shall be held in June and not same year as Executive member election.
- (d) The members of the Board of Trustees shall elect a Chairperson from among themselves.
- (e) The Board Chairperson, at his discretion, reserves the right to invite the Executive President to a board meeting
- (f) **The Functions of the Board of Trustees:**
 - (i) Serve in an advisory role both to the Executive Committee and the General Assembly.
 - (ii) Exercise oversight of the organization's financial obligations and expenditures.
 - (iii) Present any policy matter approved by a simple majority of the Board to the General Assembly for debate, voting, adoption, or rejection.
 - (iv) Review proposals submitted by members or the Executive Committee and advise the Executive Committee as needed, prior to presentation of such proposals by the Executive Committee to the General Assembly for vote, adoption, or rejection
 - (v) Initiate programs designed to enhance and promote the goals and aspirations of the Organization.
 - (vi) Assess and advise the General Assembly on Executive Committee proposals to acquire or dispose of organizational assets.
 - (vii) Receive and review Audit Committee reports with the Executive Committee before presenting them to the General Assembly

Section 3: Cultural Committee

- (a) The Cultural Committee is open to all members; however, the Chairperson and Vice Chairperson shall be appointed by the Executive Committee.
- (b) The Committee shall meet at least once every quarter, or as deemed necessary by the Chairperson especially in preparation for cultural outings, invitations, and events that are sponsored by the organization.

(e) The functions of the Cultural Committee:

- (i) Initiate and promote activities to propagate our cultural heritage, values, and traditions.
- (ii) Plan, organize, and coordinate our cultural Igbaboneli performances, invitations, exhibitions, and other traditional events.
- (iii) Collect, document, and preserve cultural materials and artifacts
- (iii) Encourage active participation of all members in cultural activities to strengthen unity and identity.
- (iv) Advise the Executive Committee and General Assembly on all cultural matters.

Section 4: Education Committee

- (a) The Education Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and at least two (2) other members appointed by the Executive Committee.
- (b) The Committee shall meet at least once each quarter, or as otherwise deemed necessary by the Chairperson or requested by the Executive Committee

(e) Functions of the Education Committee:

- (i) Organize workshops, seminars, mentorship programs, and classes to teach members' children the Esan language.
- (ii) Support members and their children pursuing higher education or vocational training.
- (iii) Coordinate all scholarship awards approved by the General Assembly
- (iv) Advise the General Assembly and encourage participation in beneficial educational opportunities. In so doing, liaise with educational institutions for scholarships and other educational programs that benefit members and their families.
- (v) Submit periodic activity reports and recommendations to the Executive Committee and General Assembly.

Section 5: Welfare Committee

- (a) The Welfare Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and at least four (4) other members appointed by the Executive Committee
- (b) The Committee shall meet regularly, particularly to address members' concerns or as deemed necessary by the Chairperson

(e) The Functions of the Welfare Committee:

- (i) Promote the general welfare and well-being of all members.
- (ii) Coordinate support during illness, bereavement, or emergencies.
- (iii) Periodically carry out welfare checks on members especially those noted to be absent in events/meetings.
- (iv) Organize welfare and condolence visits on behalf of the Organization.
- (v) Maintain records of members' welfare status and communicate with the Executive Committee.
- (vi) Recommend assistance or benefits to members in distress, subject to General Assembly approval.
- (vii) Submit periodic reports of activities and recommendations to the Executive Committee and General Assembly.

Section 6: Audit Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Auditors shall be appointed by the Executive Committee, approved by the Board of Trustees.
- (b) The Committee shall consist of three (3) members appointed at least three months before the expiration of the current Executive's tenure.
- (c) The members of the Committee shall elect a Chairperson from among themselves.
- (d) The Chairperson shall coordinate activities and preside over meetings of the Committee.

(e) The Functions of the Audit Committee:

- (i) Audit the Organization's financial records covering a minimum of twenty-four (24) months preceding the commencement of a new Administration.
- (ii) Examine receipts, expenditures, and financial statements for accuracy and compliance.

- (iii) Ensure proper internal controls and transparency in financial transactions and management.
- ((iv) Report findings and recommendations to the Board of Trustees for review, after which the reviewed report shall be presented to the General Assembly by the Committee Chairperson.

Section 7: Disciplinary Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Disciplinary Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and at least two (2) other members appointed by the Executive Committee.
- (b) The Committee shall meet at least once every quarter, or as deemed necessary by the Chairperson or Executive Committee.
- (c) All disputes brought before the Disciplinary Committee shall follow the established procedures for case referral and adjudication as set forth in the Disciplinary Rules.
- (f) The Functions of the Disciplinary Committee:**
 - (i) Investigate disputes, complaints, or misconduct involving any member(s) or officer(s) for hearing and resolution.
 - (ii) Define actions or behaviors constituting an offense, subject to General Assembly approval.
 - (iii) Ensure all proceedings are fair, transparent, and in compliance with the Disciplinary Policy.
 - (iv) Recommend sanctions and remedial measures, subject to review and approval by the General Assembly.
 - (v) Maintain accurate records of complaints, investigations, and disciplinary actions.

Section 8: Constitution Review Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Constitution Review Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and four (4) other members, appointed by the Executive Committee.
- (b) Members should include at least one past executive member and one legal advisor (if available).
- (c) The Functions of the Constitutional Review Committee:**
 - (i) Review the organization's Constitution and Bylaws to ensure they remain relevant and reflective of the organization's objectives.
 - (ii) Prepare proposals for amendments, including clear justifications and recommended wordings.
 - (iii) Present proposed changes to the General Assembly for discussion, approval, or further revision.
 - (iv) The Committee shall meet as required but must provide at least one formal report to the General Assembly before presenting any proposed amendments for ratification.

Section 9: Fundraising Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Fundraising Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and at least four (4) other members appointed by the Executive Committee.
- (b) The Committee shall meet at least once every quarter, or as deemed necessary by the Chairperson or the Executive Committee.
- (e) The Functions of the Fundraising Committee:**
 - (i) Develop and implement fundraising strategies to support the Organization's programs.
 - (ii) Identify potential donors, sponsors, and partners and cultivate relationships with them.
 - (iii) Plan, organize, and execute fundraising events, campaigns, and initiatives.
 - (iv) Seek and apply for grants from public and private sources to supplement Organization's revenues.
 - (v) Ensure proper documentation, transparency, and accountability of all funds raised.
 - (vi) Advise the Executive Committee and General Assembly on fundraising strategies and opportunities.
 - (vii) Encourage member participation in all fundraising activities.
 - (viii) Ensure members pay levies and pledges within the agreed timeframe.
 - (ix) Monitor and evaluate fundraising activities and recommend strategies for improvements.
 - (x) Regularly report activities and results to the Executive Committee and General Assembly.

Section 10: Electoral Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Electoral Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and two (2) other members, appointed

- by the Board of Trustees and shall serve for the duration of the Board's term in office.
- (b) All members of the Electoral Committee must be active members of the Organization as defined in Article III.
- (c) Members of the Electoral Committee shall not be candidates for any elective office during their term on the Committee.
- (d) If a member of the Electoral Committee wishes to run for an elective office, he must resign at least three (3) months before the election to allow the Board of Trustees to appoint a replacement.
- (e) The Functions of the Electoral Committee:**
 - (i) Oversee and supervise all electoral procedures during general elections, ensuring compliance with the Constitution and Bylaws.
 - (ii) Prepare and announce election timelines, including nomination periods, campaign guidelines, and election dates.
 - (iii) Verify eligibility of all candidates in accordance with Article III and other relevant provisions regarding eligibility.
 - (iv) Ensure fairness, transparency, and confidentiality throughout the election process.
 - (v) Address and resolve any electoral disputes arising during the election process.
 - (vi) Announce the election results immediately to the General Assembly upon the conclusion of voting.

Section 11: Membership Drive Committee (Ad-hoc)

- (a) The Membership Drive Committee shall consist of a Chairperson and four (4) other members appointed by the Executive Committee
- (b) The Public Relations Officer shall serve in an advisory capacity.

(c) Functions of the Membership Committee

- (i) Develop and implement strategies to attract eligible individuals to join the organization. This may include outreach at community events, business centers, cultural programs, and using digital platforms.
- (ii) Communicating the advantages of membership to potential and current members.
- (iii) Create promotional materials in collaboration with the Public Relations Officer.
- (iv) Identify and address factors that may discourage continued membership.
- (v) Coordinate with the Financial Secretary regarding dues and application procedures.
- (vi) Provide regular progress reports to the Executive Committee and General Assembly.

Section 12: Dissolution of Committees

- (a) All committees, including the positions of Chairperson and Vice Chairperson, except the Electoral Committee, shall dissolve at the end of the President's term.
- (b) If elected for a second term, the President has the prerogative to reshuffle or reappoint Committees and their membership or leadership to support his new agenda.
- (c) When a new President is elected, he may reappoint committee members and their chairpersons as he deems appropriate

ARTICLE VII: TERM OF OFFICE

Section 1: Executive Members

- (a) All newly elected executive members shall remain in office for a period not to exceed two years from the date of their initial or first election.
- (b) All newly elected executive members shall be sworn in and assume office at the next General Assembly meeting following the election.
- (c) All executive members shall hand over to their successors all of the Organization's properties, documents, and materials in their possession no later than two weeks after the election.
- (d) The Executive's term shall end in June of the election year, regardless of their original swearing-in month.
- (e) If no election is held in June of an election year due to lack of candidates or an act of God, the outgoing

Executive shall serve as a Caretaker Committee from July until elections are held, not exceeding three (3) months.

- (f) The Caretaker Committee's spending authority is limited to mortgage/rent and utilities.
- (g) Any financial disbursement not covered in subsection (f) shall require approval first from the Board of Trustees and then from the General Assembly. Any other expenditure shall require prior approval from the General Assembly or Board of Trustees in case of emergency.
- (h) Notwithstanding the two-term limit in Article VII, any former Executive member may run for the same or another office after eight (8) years of leaving office, provided they have continuously remained in good standing with the Organization during that period.

Section 2: Board of Trustees

- (a) All members of the Board shall remain in office for a period of two years from the date of their initial or first election.
- (b) All newly elected Board members shall be sworn in and assume office at the next general meeting following the election.
- (c) All outgoing Board members shall hand-over to the President (for on-ward transfer to the newly elected Board members) all of the Organization's properties, documents, and materials in their possession no later than three weeks after the election of the new Board members.

ARTICLE VIII: ELECTION / REMOVAL OF OFFICERS

Section 1: Election Bill

- (a) The provision of the Election Bill shall be binding in the election process of the Organization.
- (b) This bill shall be called the Organization election bill.

Section 2: Election Procedures

- (a) All candidates for both the executive committee and Board of Trustees shall file an application for the desired position at least one month prior to the date of election.
- (b) All applications shall include name, address, educational background, occupation, and a brief description of how the candidate intends to enhance the progress of the Organization.
- (c) All applications shall be typed and copies made available to all members present in the General Assembly meeting preceding the date of election.
- (d) All candidates for electoral offices shall present themselves to the General Assembly, introducing their background and the details provided in their application. The presentation shall include their proposed agenda for the intended office.
- (e) The conduct of elections shall be monitored by the Electoral Commission (Ad-hoc).
- (f) Candidates to be elected shall not be members of the Electoral Commission.
- (g) All candidates to be elected shall be present during the election.
- (h) Elections of officers shall be decided by a simple majority vote (by show of hands) of qualified members (as defined in Article III) who are present at the time of the election.
- (i) Vote by proxy shall not be permitted.
- (j) The election results shall be announced by the electoral committee immediately after the elections are held

Section 3: Eligibility

- (a) All candidates must meet the requirements stated in Article III.
- (b) Candidates for President or Vice President must have maintained active membership in good standing for at least two (2) consecutive years immediately preceding the election.
- (c) Candidates for the Board of Trustees must have maintained active membership in good standing for at least three (3) consecutive years immediately before the election and have a thorough understanding of the Organization's history, objectives, and purposes.
- (c) Candidates for all other offices must have maintained active membership in good standing for at least one (1) year immediately preceding the election.

- (d) All candidates must have attended a recognized higher institution of learning for at least two consecutive years.
- (e) Candidates for President and Vice President must hold a degree in any field from a recognized higher institution.
- (f) Candidates for Treasurer are recommended to have studied Accounting or a related field for at least two consecutive years. Otherwise, they must demonstrate knowledge of basic accounting principles and bookkeeping.
- (i) All candidates must be current in all dues and approved levies, with any delinquency not exceeding three months.

Section 4: Conditions for Removal / Dismissal of Officer(s)

- (a) Expiration of term and or new election or
- (b) Voluntary resignation or,
- (c) Proof of negligence or,
- (d) Proof of abuse of office (may include misrepresentation of ones credentials to the Organization, embezzlement, corruption, bribery, misconduct etc.) or
- (e) Proof of any criminal conviction or
- (f) Any other circumstance that may militate against the moral standard expected of a member of the Organization. In this regard, such circumstance shall be defined by the Executive members or Board members and approved by a two-third majority vote of the general membership present at the General Assembly meeting during which the said circumstance was defined, argued, or debated.

Section 5: Procedure for Dismissal of Officer(s)

- (a) Proof(s) of negligence of duty, abuse of office, and criminal record shall be submitted in writing to the executive committee and the Board of Trustees for review and recommendation.
- (b) Any member may submit a written petition for review of such allegations, notwithstanding prior recommendations.
- (c) Emergency meeting of the General Assembly may be called if the officer in question refuses to tender a written notice of his resignation and return all properties/materials belonging to the Organization after a due process determines such individual to be ineligible to hold an office.
- (d) The President shall serve an official notice of dismissal to any officer that becomes ineligible to hold an office. If the President is the officer in question, the Board of Trustees shall serve the demoted President such an official notice of dismissal.
- (e) The due process referred to in (c) above shall include but not limited to the following:
 - (i) A consultative meeting between the accused officer and other officers convened by the President or the Board of Trustees.
 - (ii) Submission of written counter-evidence by the accused officer, where applicable.
 - (iii) If applicable, presentation of proof against the accused and/or counter evidence by the accused officer to a General Assembly in a regular or emergency meeting.
 - (iv) A vote of the General Assembly on the merits of the case.
 - (v) A simple majority vote of members present shall determine whether the officer is retained or dismissed.

ARTICLE IX: MEETINGS

Section 1: Frequency

- (a) The General Assembly shall meet at least once a month.
- (b) The General Assembly meeting shall be held every second Sunday of the month throughout the year.
- (c) The executive committee shall meet regularly at least one week in advance of the monthly General Assembly meeting or at the President's request/discretion.
- (d) If a scheduled general meeting coincides with a "special event" or important holiday, the President may request, at least one month in advance, to hold the meeting virtually or cancel it entirely, subject to approval by the General Assembly.

Section 2: Special / Emergency Meetings

- (a) Emergency or special meetings shall be called as necessary by the President.
- (b) Emergency or special meetings may be called by any member in good standing provided such meetings are approved by the executive committee or the Board of Trustees or by a simple majority of the members present at the preceding General Assembly meeting.

Section 3: Quorum

- (a) Up to one-third of active members may open a General Meeting, with the President or Vice President presiding, but no binding decisions may be made until a two-thirds quorum is present.
- (b) At Executive and Board meetings, a quorum requires three Executive members and four Board members, respectively. Without a quorum, the meeting cannot begin.
- (c) Except as provided elsewhere in this Constitution, approval of decisions of the General Assembly or Executive Members or Board Members shall be determined by a simple majority vote of the members present at the meeting at which the decision was made.

ARTICLE X : REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND BANKING

Section 1 : Sources of Revenues

- (a) Revenue shall be generated from membership fees; monthly dues; donations; special contributions and/or levies; and interest from the Organization's Bank Accounts.
- (b) All members as defined in Article III, Sections (2) and (3) shall pay membership fees, monthly dues and special levies approved by the General Assembly.
- (c) The Organization may organize and implement fundraising activities such as car washing, sale of Esan artifacts, community work, parties, raffles, etc. spearheaded by the Fundraising Committee.
- (d) The Organization shall accept donations or contributions from all well-wishers.
- (e) The Organization may also receive grants as a source of revenue, which shall be sought through applications to governmental, private, or corporate funding sources.
- (f) Sources of revenue shall not be limited to those stated above.

Section 2: Dues

- (a) Monthly dues shall be \$40 per member (\$30 actual dues and \$10 allocated to the Benefit Fund)
- (b) Membership registration fee of \$50.00 is payable when the membership application is submitted.
- (c) Monthly dues shall be payable at the monthly General Assembly meetings unless paid in advance (late payments shall be accepted).
- (d) Monthly dues and membership fees may be changed only by a simple majority of members present at the General Assembly meeting upon proposal by the Executive Committee.
- (e) Dues and membership fees shall be reviewed at least every five (5) years and presented to the General Assembly for approval.

Section 3: Expenditures

- (a) All expenses of the Organization shall be paid for from the revenues generated as outlined in Article X.
- (b) The Organization shall attempt to make a total yearly contribution (not to exceed 5% of annual net income) to any charitable Organization(s) of its choice and in whatever proportion(s) of the 5% of annual net income as it deem fit.

Section 4: Banking And Accounts

- (a) The Organization shall maintain bank accounts exclusively with banks that are insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC), as approved by a two-thirds majority of members present at a General Meeting.
- (b) No single account shall hold a balance exceeding \$250,000.00 at any one bank.
- (c) No individual member shall use any of the Organization's bank accounts or funds for personal purposes.
- (d) The Organization shall maintain three distinct bank accounts:
 - 1. Capital Project Account – Restricted (for building and other approved projects)

2. Welfare Monies Account – Restricted (for benefits and donations intended to assist members)
3. Operating Account – Unrestricted (for dues, levies, fines, and general operation)

Section 5: Financial Expenditure Authority

- (a) The President, Treasurer, and Secretary shall be the only authorized signatories for all financial transactions of the Organization, including cash withdrawals, check payments, electronic transfers, and any other disbursements.
- (b) All withdrawals shall require the signatures of two authorized signatories, except that the President may independently disburse up to five hundred dollars (\$500.00) for emergencies or exigent circumstances without prior authorization from the Executive Committee or General House.
- (c) Any single expenditure exceeding five hundred dollars (\$500) but not more than five thousand dollars (\$5,000) shall require the approval of the Board of Trustees before disbursement.
- (d) Any single expenditure exceeding five thousand dollars (\$5,000) shall require the approval of the General House before disbursement.
- (e) All expenditures, regardless of amount, shall be duly recorded, reported in the organization's financial records, and presented in the periodic financial report to the General House.

Section 6: Methods of Payments Requiring Authorization

- (a) All authorized payments shall be made by check or wire transfer and shall require two signatures, in accordance with Article X, Section 5(b), except as provided in subsection (b).
- (b) Payments through Zelle or similar electronic platforms are permitted only for non-capital expenditures and shall not exceed two thousand dollars (\$2,000) per transaction, and shall require prior approval by two authorized signatories.

- (a) All authorized payments shall be made by check or wire transfer and shall require two signatures in accordance with Article X, Section 5(b).
- (b) Payments through Zelle or similar electronic platforms are permitted only for non-capital expenditures and shall not exceed two thousand dollars (\$2,000) per transaction.

All such payments must be supported by clear documentation, including the purpose of the expense, proof of payment, and a receipt or invoice, and must be submitted to the Financial Secretary and Treasurer for record-keeping.

Use of these platforms shall not replace standard financial authorization procedures, except as otherwise provided in **Article X, Section 5(a)** regarding the President's limited emergency spending authority.

ARTICLE XI: AWARDS

Section 1: Privileges

- (a) The Executive Committee shall have the privilege to award any special recognition or certificate(s) of appreciation to outstanding members i.e. Outstanding Member Award(s).
- (b) The General Assembly shall have the privilege to award any non-monetary special recognition to any individual who may have rendered outstanding services to the Organization i.e. Outstanding Service Award.

Section 2: Nomination

- (a) The Executive Committee shall, with the approval of the Board of Trustees, nominate a member for the Outstanding Member Award.
- (b) Any member in good standing may nominate another member in good standing for the Outstanding Member Award(s), provided a detailed written account of the achievements of such a nominee is submitted one month in advance of the date of such award to the Executive Committee.

Section 3: Presentation

- (a) Awards shall be presented by the President at an appropriate time, preferably during the end-of-year celebration.
- (b) Other awards (e.g. honorary membership) may be presented at the most appropriate time as determined by the Executive Committee.

ARTICLE XII: ANNUAL EVENTS

- (a) The Organization shall host annual events designed to promote unity, cultural enrichment, and social engagement among members and their families.
- (b) The following shall be recognized as official annual events of the Organization:
 - (i) Summer Picnic.
 - (ii) End-of-Year Celebration.
- (c) These events shall be inclusive of members' children and families and shall provide opportunities for:
 - (i) Social interaction and bonding among families.
 - (ii) Cultural education and heritage appreciation for children.
- (d) Both events shall be organized in collaboration with the Esan Women Association.
- (e) **The Summer Picnic** shall include family-centered recreational activities and cultural engagement suitable for children and youths.
- (f) The summer Picnic shall be held between June and July depending on the availability of a conducive location.
- (g) **The End-of-Year Celebration** shall include initiatives such as:
 - (i) Presentation of scholarship awards to children and youths who have been pre-screened by the Education Committee.
 - (ii) Recognition of academic, cultural, or leadership achievements by members' children.
 - (iii) Performances or exhibitions by the Cultural Committee.
 - (iv) Mentorship or youth empowerment activities, as appropriate.
- (h) The End-of-Year Celebration Party shall be held in the month of December on a date determined by the Executive Committee in consultation with the Esan Women Association.
- (i) Voluntary monetary donations from members shall be accepted to supplement and offset expenses associated with the planning and execution of these events, as appropriate.
- (j) Voluntary donations of food and drinks by UEO and EWA members shall be accepted.
- (k) The General Assembly may create, modify, or discontinue annual events or related initiatives by resolution.
- (l) The Executive Committee shall appoint an appropriate Ad-hoc committee to plan and execute each annual event, and each such committee shall include at least one Executive Committee member.

ARTICLE XIII: GENERAL PROVISIONS**Section 1. Suspension of Mandatory Requirements**

- (a) Any mandatory provision of this Constitution shall be delayed, modified, waived, or suspended by a resolution of the General Assembly when circumstances warrant.
- (b) Approval shall require an affirmative vote of at least two-thirds (2/3) of the members present and eligible to vote at a duly convened General Assembly meeting.

Section 2. Extraordinary Circumstances

- (a) In the event of an emergency, natural disaster, public health crisis, government restriction, Force Majeure, or other circumstance that substantially interferes with the operations of the Organization, the General Assembly shall, by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of members present and eligible to vote, authorize temporary measures necessary to carry out the purposes of the Organization, provided such measures do not conflict with applicable law.
- (b) Where such circumstances make it impossible, impracticable, or unsafe to convene the General Assembly, the Executive Committee, in consultation with the Board of Trustees, may authorize temporary measures necessary to manage the affairs of the Organization.
- (c) Any such measures shall be promptly communicated to the General Assembly and shall remain in effect only if ratified by the General Assembly within fourteen (14) calendar days from the start date of such measures.

Section 3. Limitations

- (a) Any action taken under this Article shall be temporary in nature and shall not constitute an amendment to this Constitution.
- (b) Any vote under this Article shall be subject to the quorum and voting requirements of this Constitution.

ARTICLE XIV: ADDENDUMS

Benefits and Disciplinary Rules

- (a) The organization shall maintain separate documents titled “*Benefit Rules*” and “*Disciplinary Policy*”, which shall govern matters relating to member benefits and discipline, respectively.
- (b) These Rules shall be developed, maintained, and amended by the Executive Committee and ratified by the General Assembly.
- (c) The Rules shall complement this Constitution and provide detailed procedures for implementation of its relevant provisions.
- (d) In the event of any conflict between this Constitution and either set of Rules, the provisions of this Constitution shall prevail.

ARTICLE XV: AMENDMENTS / RATIFICATION

Section 1: Privilege

- (a) The privilege of proposing and approving amendments to this Constitution rests with the general membership with voting rights, in accordance with the procedures established herein.
- (b) A proposed amendment to this Constitution may be initiated by a written petition signed by not fewer than ten (10) members in good standing or by resolution of the Executive Committee.
The petition shall state the section(s) to be amended, the proposed changes, and the rationale. The petition shall be submitted to the Secretary, who shall circulate the proposal to all members at least one month prior to the General Assembly meeting where it will be considered.
- (c) Amendments shall be approved by a simple majority vote of the general membership with voting rights present at a General Assembly meeting during which the amendment(s) is/are motioned.

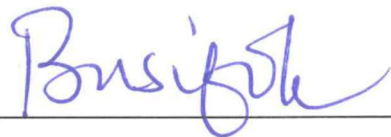
Section 2: Ratification

Ratification of this constitution shall be by at a simple majority vote of the general membership with voting rights present at the General Assembly meeting during which ratification is motioned.

Constitution Review Committee

1. Mr. Abumere Adodo
2. Mr. George Adodo
3. Pastor Samuel Ainabe
4. Mr. Anthony Obeahon
5. Mr. Jonathan Okojiabulu

**Resolved and Adopted by the UEO General Assembly on this
13th Day of September 2026**

 09/13/2026

Barrister Bright Usifoh, Chairman Board of Trustees

 9/13/2026

Mr. Jude Daudu, Executive President of UEO

 9/13/2026

Mr. Anthony Obeahon, Chairman Constitution Review Committee